

at cell D6 on Sheet1 of Book2. In order for this to work, you will need to make sure that Book2 is open at the same time that your main workbook is open.



### Advanced Filtering

There are some situations in which AutoFilter just can't cope up. For instance, you might need to perform a calculation in a filter comparison. In these cases, you can use the advanced filtering capabilities of Excel.

Advanced filtering requires that you set up a criteria range in your worksheet. This criteria range is not part of your data list, but instead is used to signify how you want filtering to be performed. Typically, you would place your criteria before your data list, but you can also place it after. The important thing is that you separate your criteria from your data list by at least one empty row. Otherwise, Excel may think that the criteria are part of the actual data list. The criteria are entered in your worksheet such that each column represents a different logical AND comparison, and each row represents a different logical OR comparison. An example is in order here.

Let's say you have a data list that starts in the sixth row of a worksheet. You have set aside the rows above this to specify your filtering criteria. The data list contains columns that describe information in your inventory. There are columns for item numbers, description, location, quantity, value, and the like. There is also a calculated column that indicates the loss derived from each inventory item.

At some time you may want to filter your data list so it shows only a limited subset of your inventory items. For instance, you might want to see only those items for which the quantity is over 2,500 and loss is less than 1,000, or those items where the quantity is greater than 7,500, or those items where

loss is under 100. This is much more complex than you can perform using a custom AutoFilter.

To set up such a filter, all you need to do is set your criteria. In this case, you would use cells A1:B4 as follows:

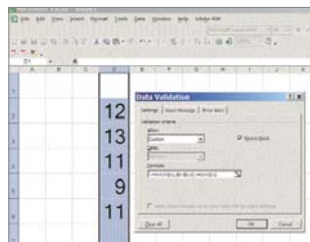
|   | A        | B     |
|---|----------|-------|
| 1 | Quantity | Loss  |
| 2 | >2500    | <1000 |
| 3 | >7500    |       |
| 4 |          | <100  |

The first row shows the field names to be used in comparisons, while the second through fourth rows define the actual comparisons. Notice that because there are two tests in the second row, these are considered an AND condition, and those on the other rows are considered OR conditions.

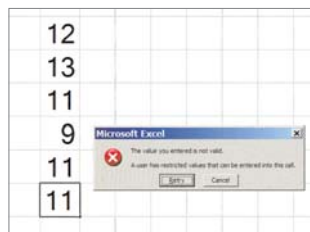
To apply these filtering criteria, follow these steps: first select any cell in the data list (not in the criteria). Choose Data > Filter. Choose the 'Advanced Filter' option from the submenu. Excel displays the 'Advanced Filter' dialog box. The 'List Range' should automatically be set to your data list. Select the 'Criteria Range' field. The insertion point should appear within the field. Use the mouse to select the criteria range, cells A1:B4. Click 'OK'.



### Ensuring Unique Values In A Column



To ensure unique values, you can use Data Validation for the range



With Data Validation, typing in an incorrect value brings up an error

When you are entering information in a worksheet, you may want to ensure that the data being entered is actually unique for a particular column. For instance, if you are entering a series of invoice numbers in column D of a worksheet, you may want to ensure that you don't enter the same invoice number twice.

There are a couple of ways you can approach such a problem. If you are always entering your new information at the bottom of a column, you can use Excel's data validation feature to make sure that whatever you are entering in the current cell does not match anything higher up in the column. Simply follow these steps: first, select column D. Choose 'Validation' from the 'Data' menu. Excel displays the 'Data Validation' dialog box. Using the 'Allow' drop-down list, choose the 'Custom' option. In the 'Formula' box, enter the following formula: `=MATCH(D1,$D:$D,0)=ROW(D1)`

Click 'OK'. If you may be entering data anywhere within column D, and you want to know if you are entering a value that is elsewhere in the column (above or below the current cell), then you can follow the above steps, but use this formula instead: `=COUNTIF($D:$D,D1)<2`



### Dynamic Hyperlinks

You can create dynamic hyperlinks in Excel that act like HTML forms without having to know much about HTML. These hyperlinks can come in handy when using Excel as an interface to the Internet. As an example, let's create a Google search form. First, do a Google search for the keyword "Excel." Then, take a look at the URL in your browser's address bar. It may look something like this:

`http://www.google.com/search?hl=en&q=Excel&lr=lang_en`

The parameters following the question mark (?) are the name-value pairs submitted by the HTML form. But, you don't need to know a whole lot about that. In this case,



### Bet You Didn't Know

#### Jumping Around Folders

If you work with multiple workbooks at the same time, you know that traversing folder (directory) paths in the Open dialog box can be tedious. Say you have a workbook you're working on. You open a second workbook in a different directory. Now comes the time to open a third workbook. When you display the 'Open' dialog box, Excel assumes you want to start from where you opened the previous workbook. What if you want to actually open it from the same directory in which the first workbook was located? Of course, you can again use the 'Open' dialog box to traverse back to the original directory. An easier method is to display the first workbook, then choose 'Save As'. Excel displays the 'Save As' dialog box, starting from the directory in which the workbook was originally loaded. (This is the directory you want.) Close the 'Save As' dialog box! Now, when you use the 'Open' dialog box, Excel starts in the folder you were last in—the one you want.

the main thing to consider is the search term, where "q" is the name of the parameter, and "Excel" is the value.

Using the HYPERLINK function along with the CONCATENATE function (or just the ampersand), you can easily assemble a link and create a dynamic form using cells as fields: in cell B3, enter the keyword "Excel Web Queries." And in cell B4, enter the following formula: `=HYPERLINK("http://www.google.com/search?q="&B3&"&safe=active","Search Google")`

Now you have your own simple HTML form inside Excel. You can create much longer hyperlinks and include multiple cell references, but there is a limit in Excel to how long the hyperlink can be (about 248 characters). To use the form, just enter your keywords into cell B3, and click on the hyperlink in cell B4.